

Dan Payne

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SUMMARY

Azure-focused Site Reliability and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer with proven experience designing, operating, and securing production Azure environments. Microsoft Certified Azure Solutions Architect Expert with strong expertise in reliability engineering, automation, CI/CD pipelines, and incident response. Skilled in building scalable, fault tolerant, and observable systems while reducing operational toil through automation. Brings a reliability-first mindset informed by an aviation education background, emphasizing safety, consistency, and continuous improvement.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Systems Administrator, Catalyst Solutions – Greenwood Village, CO

Nov 2022 – Present

- Design, operate, and maintain Azure based cloud infrastructure supporting mission critical business systems with a focus on reliability, scalability, and security.
- Apply Site Reliability Engineering principles including proactive monitoring, incident response, root cause analysis, and continuous improvement of production systems.
- Lead incident response and escalation efforts, coordinating mitigation, documenting post incident findings, and implementing corrective actions to prevent recurrence.
- Build and maintain CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps, including pipelines created from scratch to support system integrations and automated deployments.
- Automate infrastructure and operational workflows using PowerShell, Azure CLI, ARM, Bicep, and Terraform to reduce manual toil and configuration drift.
- Implement observability solutions using Azure Monitor and Log Analytics to track system health, performance, and operational metrics.
- Drive cost awareness and performance tuning by balancing resource utilization, scalability, and business requirements.
- Enforce security, governance, and compliance best practices using Entra ID, RBAC, Conditional Access, and Zero Trust principles.
- Partner with engineering, operations, and leadership teams in an agile environment to support platform improvements and reliability initiatives.
- Lead service desk operations, providing Tier 2 and Tier 3 support, mentoring team members, and improving operational processes.
- Own IT asset lifecycle management and audit readiness across the organization.

Escrow Officer, Realogy – Guardian Title – Greenwood Village, CO

Dec 2019 – Sep 2022

- Oversaw full lifecycle of real estate transactions for Richmond American Homes.
- Balanced financial figures and ensured compliance with escrow procedures.
- Managed high-volume communication with clients, lenders, and agents.
- Utilized proprietary systems for data entry and financial reconciliation.

Resource Coordinator, Realogy – Coldwell Banker Burnet – Edina, MN

May 2017 – Nov 2019

- Maintained and optimized automated lead distribution systems.
- Handled large volumes of online customer inquiries.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cloud & Site Reliability Engineering
Microsoft Azure (VMs, App Services, Functions, Storage, Networking, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics), Azure Entra ID (RBAC, Conditional Access, MFA), Infrastructure Reliability, Incident Response, Observability, Cost Awareness
- Automation, CI/CD & Infrastructure as Code
Azure DevOps (Pipelines, Boards, Repos), GitHub Actions, ARM Templates, Bicep, Terraform, PowerShell, Azure CLI, Bash
- Systems, Identity & Security
Microsoft Intune, Endpoint Manager, Windows and Linux Server, Okta SSO and Identity Management, Zero Trust Architecture, Security Baselines, Compliance Controls
- Software & Integration
JavaScript, Python, Node.js, REST APIs, Webhooks, JSON, Express.js, SQL, MongoDB, Postman
- Productivity & Tools
Microsoft 365 (Excel, Word, Outlook, PowerPoint), QuickBooks, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop

EDUCATION

South Dakota State University – Brookings, SD

B.S. in Aviation Education | Sep 2000 – May 2004

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert**
Credential ID: B8BCF0101869195D
Certification Number: 24X54D-6D4675
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate**
Credential ID: 577798C2139F1274
Certification Number: 2FEA4B-9A8921
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals**
Credential ID: 7508E4DDC453E79F
Certification Number: C0DAA3-1436EC
- **Notary Public (State of Colorado)**
Credential ID: 20194046894